

**UNIT
4**

**THE INFINITIVE
/ -ING FORM
/ -ING/-ED
ADJECTIVES**

UNIT 4 THE INFINITIVE / -ING FORM / -ING/-ED ADJECTIVES

	Forms of the Infinitive		Forms of the -ing form	
	Active voice	Passive voice	Active voice	Passive voice
Present	(to) repair	(to) be repaired	-	-
Present Continuous	(to) be repairing	-	repairing	being repaired
Perfect	(to) have repaired	(to) have been repaired	-	-
Perfect Continuous	(to) have been repairing	-	having repaired	having been repaired

- The **Present Infinitive** refers to the present or future.
I hope **to meet** her tonight.
- The **Present Continuous Infinitive** expresses an action **happening** now.
He must **be sleeping** now.
- The **Perfect Infinitive** is used to show that the action of the infinitive happened before the action of the verb.
He claims **to have worked** here before. (First he worked here, then he claimed he had worked here.)
- The **Perfect Continuous Infinitive** is used to emphasize the duration of the action of the infinitive, which happened before the action of the main verb.
He looks tired. He seems **to have been studying** for the test all night.

The Present Continuous, the Perfect and the Perfect Continuous Infinitives are used with the verbs: appear, claim, happen, pretend, seem, etc., and with modal verbs.

- The **Present Gerund** (-ing form) refers to the present or future.
Sara enjoys **walking** in the woods.
- The **Perfect Gerund** (-ing form) shows that the action of the **-ing form** has happened before the action of the main verb. We

can use the Present Gerund instead of the Perfect Gerund without a difference in meaning.

She regretted **having missed** the meeting.

OR

She regretted **missing** the meeting.

The to infinitive is used:

- **to express purpose.**
He went to university **to become** a lawyer. (in order to become)
- **after certain verbs such as agree, appear, decide, expect, hope, plan, promise, refuse, etc.**
He **refused to pay** the bill.
- **after certain adjectives which describe feelings/emotions (happy, glad, sorry, etc.).**
She was **happy to win** the prize.
- **after would like / would love / would prefer, etc. to express a specific preference.**
I **would like to see** the manager.
- **after certain nouns.**
What a **surprise to see** him there!
- **after too / enough.**
He's **too young to have** his own car.
He's **clever enough to do** the crossword.
- **with it + be + adjective (+ of + noun / pronoun).**
It was generous of him to offer £1,000.
- **with so + adjective + as.**
Would you be **so kind as to help** me move the sofa?
- **with only to express an unsatisfactory result.**
She came in **only to find** Bob had left.

The -ing form is used:

- **as a noun.**
Walking is good exercise.
 - **after certain verbs (admit, anticipate, appreciate, avoid, consider, continue, deny, discuss, enjoy, escape, excuse, fancy, finish, forgive, go for (activities), imagine, involve, keep (= continue), mention, mind, miss, object to, postpone, practise, prevent, quit, recall, recollect, report, resent, resist, risk, save, stand, suggest, tolerate, understand, etc.).**
They **discussed selling** the company.
"Let's **go jogging!**" "No, I'd rather go sailing."
 - **after dislike, enjoy, hate, like, love, prefer to express general preference.**
She **likes painting.** (in general)
- Note:** like + to infinitive = it is considered a good idea
I **like to wash** my hair every day.
- **after I'm busy, it's no use, it's (no) good, it's (not) worth, what's the use of, can't help, there's no point (in), can't stand, have difficulty (in), in addition to, as well as, have trouble, have a hard/difficult**

- **after be + the first/second, etc. / next / last / best, etc.**
He **was the last to come** to work.
- **in the expression for + noun /pronoun + to infinitive.**
For him to be so rude was unforgivable.
- **in the expressions to tell you the truth, to begin with, to be honest, etc.**
To be honest, I don't like him.

Note: If two infinitives are joined by and or or, the to of the second infinitive can be omitted. I want to call Mr. Jones and fax or post him a letter.

time.

He **can't stand being treated** like a slave.

He **had difficulty finding** his way back.

- **after spend / waste (time, money, etc.).**

He **spends** his free time **digging** (in) the garden.

- **after prepositions.**

He left the shop **without paying**, so he was accused of **stealing**.

- **after look forward to, be / get used to, be / get accustomed to, object to, admit (to), etc.**

I'm **looking forward to hearing** from you soon.

- **after verbs of sensation/ perception such as hear, listen, notice, see, watch to express an incomplete action, i.e. somebody saw or heard only a part of the action.**

I **saw** Tim **doing** his homework. (I saw part of the action in progress. I didn't wait until he had finished.)

- **BUT hear, listen, see, watch + infinitive without to expresses a complete action, i.e. something that somebody saw or heard from beginning to end.**

I **saw** Tim **do** his homework. (I saw the whole action from beginning to end.)

EXERCISES

Exercise: 1

Write what each verb/phrase is followed by: to infinitive, infinitive without to or -ing form.

1. enjoy + -ing form
2. promise + _____
3. be made + _____
4. object to + _____
5. it's no use + _____
6. can't stand + _____
7. can't help + _____
8. resist + _____
9. agree + _____
10. would like + _____
11. refuse + _____
12. spend time + _____
13. avoid + _____
14. be the first + _____
15. tolerate + _____

Exercise: 2

Fill in the correct form of the infinitives.

1. My boss expects me to work (work) overtime tonight.
2. The suspect claimed _____ (work) at the time of the

robbery.

3. I was sorry _____ (hear) that she had failed the exam.

4. The burglars must have come in through the window as the lock seems _____ (force).

5. Ali appears _____ (overtake) Zain on the last lap. "Yes, he's passed him!"

6. Sami was the last runner _____ (finish) the marathon.

7. I'd like _____ (book) a return ticket to London, please.

8. Stop pretending _____ (eat) your food – just finish it up, please.

9. It was very kind of Sarah _____ (lend) me her laptop.

10. Sofia seems _____ (enjoy) her new job.

11. Zain plans _____ (start) his own business after she graduates.

12. Sarah appears _____ (get) annoyed with her neighbour now.

Exercise: 3

Underline the correct preposition and fill in the gaps with the ing form of the verb in brackets.

1. It was difficult for Sarah to get used **to / with** living (live) in a foreign country.

2. Sami is looking forward **about / to** _____ (travel) across Asia this summer.

3. In addition **of / to** _____ (clean) his room, Ali also did

the washing-up.

4. Zain is habitual **to / in** _____ (work) long hours in the office.

5. There's no point **in / about** _____ (ask) me again – I've made up my mind.

6. Ali admitted **to / in** _____ (wear) her sister's top without asking.

7. What's the use **of / with** _____ (paint) the house if we are going to sell it soon?

8. As well **as / with** _____ (raise) money for children, the charity offers advice to parents.

Exercise: 4

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct infinitive form or -ing form.

The New York City Marathon

Every year, New Yorkers look forward to 1) seeing
(see) one of the world's greatest races take place on their streets – The New York City



Marathon! About 40,000 people including celebrities, world-class athletes, and, of course, people who just want 2) _____
(have) fun, enjoy 3) _____ (run) this famous race each year! To finish the race, runners must 4) _____
(complete) a 26.2 mile course. Two million people and more than 100 music bands cheer them on from the streets. The atmosphere

is so fantastic many runners consider 5) _____ (cross) the finishing line in Central Park to be one of the best feelings in the world! Would you like 6) _____ (take part) in the NYC marathon? All you need to do is put your name on a list. Afraid you are too unfit 7) _____ (enter)? Don't be! 8) _____ (walk) is entirely acceptable. In fact, over the years, people as old as 88 have completed the marathon. What's more, you may just 9) _____ (win) some of the \$800,000 prize money that is up for grabs. Good luck!

Exercise: 5

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct infinitive form or the -ing form.

1. A: Hasan was the first to finish **(finish)** the English test.

B: Yes, but _____ **(tell)** you the truth, I don't think he did very well.

2. A: Good evening. We would like _____ **(sit)** by the window, please.

B: Certainly. If you would be so kind as _____ **(follow)** me, I'll show you to your table.

3. A: You should _____ **(see)** his face when she told him the news.

B: He must _____ **(be)** really surprised.

4. A: I'd love _____ **(lie)** on the beach right now instead of typing reports.

B: Me, too. Just imagine _____ **(be)** under the sun with nothing to worry about.

Subject of the infinitive / -ing form

• **The subject of the infinitive or the -ing form is omitted when it is the same as the subject of the main verb.**

I want to help with the preparations.

• **When it is different from the subject of the verb, then an object pronoun (me, you, him, her, it, us, you, them), a name or a noun is placed before the infinitive or the -ing form.**

I want him/John/my brother to help with the preparations.

• **The subject of the -ing form can be an object pronoun, a possessive adjective (my, your, etc.), a name or a possessive case.**

I remember him/his/Sami/Sami's talking about that island.

Exercise: 6

Rephrase the following using the infinitive or the -ing form, as in the example.

1. You have to eat your carrots.

I want you to eat carrots.

2. I must exercise more often.

I want _____.

3. She has to take her medicine every day.

The doctor wants _____.

4. I saw him give you the letter.

I remember _____.

5. He has to talk to me politely.

I want _____.

6. I mustn't go to bed late.

I don't want _____.

7. We visited Zain last weekend.

I remember _____.

8. Sarah sang that song last week.

I remember _____.

Verbs taking to infinitive or -ing form without a change in meaning

- **begin, continue, intend, start + to infinitive or -ing form.**
She **began crying/to cry**.

- **However, we never have two -ing forms together.**
The days **are beginning to get** shorter.

- **advise, allow, encourage, permit, recommend, take the to infinitive when they are followed by an object or when they are in the passive form. They take the -ing form when they are not followed by an object.**

He advised us to leave early. (object)

We were advised **to leave** early. (passive)

We advise **leaving** early. (no object)

- **need, require, want are followed by to-infinitive, the -ing form or the passive infinitive.**

You **need to polish** your shoes.

Your shoes **need polishing**.

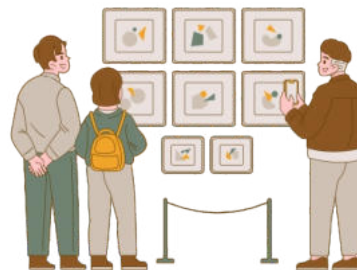
Your shoes **need to be polished**.

Exercise: 7

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct infinitive form or -ing form.

Museum Rules and Information

- All visitors are required 1) to show (show) their ticket upon entering each section of the museum.
- Visitors are not permitted 2) _____ (touch) works of art or to lean on the cases.
- We advise 3) _____ (keep) a safe distance between you and each work of art.
- Visitors are encouraged 4) _____ (speak) quietly in the museum.
- We do not allow 5) _____ (smoke) inside the museum building.



Exercise: 8

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct infinitive form or -ing form.

Extreme Sports – DO SOMETHING DIFFERENT!

Extreme sports are not for everyone. But for people who enjoy 1) living (**live**) life to the full, they are the only type of sports worth 2)

_____ (**do**)! The latest extreme sport to become popular is sandboarding. It involves 3) _____ (**slide**) down



extremely high sand dunes on a board. You can 4) _____
(lie down) or stand up. When standing up, both your feet are tied
to the board to prevent you from 5) _____ **(fall off)**.
Some sandboarders, however, prefer 6) _____ **(keep)**
their feet untied because it allows more freedom of movement.
Lying down can be even more fun. Can you imagine 7)
_____ **(speed)** headfirst down a sand dune at 80km/hr?
Because that's how fast you can expect 8) _____ **(go)**!
Sounds like fun? People who have tried sandboarding say it's
totally addictive! So head to a desert and try it out. You don't
need 9) _____ **(have)** any experience, but you should
10) _____ **(love)** danger and excitement!

Verbs taking to infinitive or -ing form with a change in meaning

• forget + to infinitive (= forget to do sth) I'm sorry, I forgot to lock the car. • forget + -ing form (= forget a past event) We'll never forget visiting Paris.	• try + to infinitive (= do one's best; attempt) She tried hard to cope with her new job. • try + -ing form (= do sth as an experiment) Try adding some more sauce to your pasta.
• remember + to infinitive (= remember to do sth) Remember to read the instructions. • remember + -ing form (= recall a past event) I don't remember meeting Al before.	• want + to infinitive (= wish) I want to find a better job. • want + -ing form (= sth needs to be done) Your dress wants cleaning.
• mean + to infinitive (= intend to) He means to move to	• stop + to infinitive (= pause temporarily)

Newcastle.

mean + -ing form (= involve)
Working harder means getting more money.

- **go on + to infinitive** (= finish doing sth and start doing sth else)
After finishing her BA, she went on to get a master's degree.
go on + -ing form (= continue)
She went on watching TV.

- **regret + to infinitive** (= be sorry to do sth)
I regret to tell you that you have failed.
regret + -ing form (= have second thoughts about sth already done)
He regrets telling lies when he was young.

- **would prefer + to infinitive** (specific preference)
I'd prefer to have an early night tonight.
prefer + -ing form (in general)
I prefer reading a book to watching TV.
prefer + to infinitive + (rather) than + infinitive without to
I prefer to read a book (rather) than watch TV.

He **stopped to buy** some milk on his way home.

stop + -ing form (= finish)
Stop talking to each other, please!

- **be sorry + to infinitive** (= regret)
I'm sorry to hear he has been injured.
be sorry for + -ing form (= apologise for an earlier action)
I'm sorry for misunderstanding /having misunderstood what you said.

- **hate + to infinitive** (= feel sorry that you have to ask, interrupt, etc.)
I hate to interrupt, but I must talk to you.

hate + -ing form (= feel sorry for what one is doing)
I hate making you feel uncomfortable.

- **be afraid + to infinitive** (= the subject feels anxious about doing sth)
I'm afraid to drive over the old bridge.

be afraid of + -ing form (= the subject is afraid that what is described by the -ing form may happen)
She is afraid of breaking her leg if she jumps over the wall.



• Somebody = **sb**

Something = **sth**

Know This

Exercise: 9

Put the verbs in brackets into the infinitive or -ing form.

1. Ali stopped to pick up **(pick up)** his dry cleaning on the way home.
2. If you don't stop _____ **(eat)** so much chocolate, you'll make yourself ill.
3. Try _____ **(phone)** John at the office if he's not at home.
4. I tried my best _____ **(finish)** the test, but there just wasn't enough time.
5. He was promoted in 1990 and went on _____ **(become)** a company director.
6. The band went on _____ **(play)** even after the lights had gone out.
7. Zain was afraid _____ **(show)** her school report to her parents.
8. I'm afraid of _____ **(lose)** my way in the forest.
9. What do you mean _____ **(do)** with all that money?
10. Playing a musical instrument well means _____ **(practise)** for years.
11. I regret _____ **(tell)** you that your appointment has been cancelled.
12. She regrets _____ **(spend)** so much money on her new dress.

13. Do you remember _____ **(ride)** a bicycle for the first time?

14. Remember _____ **(post)** the letters on your way home.

Exercise: 10

Put the verbs in brackets into the infinitive or -ing form.

Zara: Sofia ! I've been meaning 1) to ask **(ask)** you. Did you pass your driving test?

Sofia: No, I'm afraid I didn't.

Zara: Oh! I'm really sorry 2) _____ **(hear)** that. Did your examiner say why?

Sofia: Yes. He said I didn't remember 3) _____ **(look)** in my rearview mirror when I was reversing. Although I really don't remember 4) _____ **(forget)** to do that!

Zara: Oh. That's a pity.

Sofia: He also said that I forgot 5) _____ **(signal)** that I was turning on two occasions. And that I didn't stop 6) _____ **(look)** when I went through an intersection. I have to admit to those mistakes though.

Zara: Oh, dear. Are you very upset you failed?

Sofia: A bit. I'm trying 7) _____ **(forget)** about it.

Zara: Look, you just need some more lessons.

Sofia: That's what my examiner said. He told me not to give up.

Zara: Hey, I've got an idea! Why don't you try 8) _____ **(take)** lessons with my dad? He taught me to drive. He's a really good

teacher.

Sofia: Thanks. But my brother says he wants 9) _____ **(help)** me. I'd prefer 10) _____ **(get)** lessons from him.

Zara: OK. No problem. Just let me know if there's anything else I can do to help.

Sofia: Thanks! I will.

Exercise: 11

Put the verbs in brackets into the correct passive infinitive or -ing form.

1. We are waiting for his first novel to be published **(publish)** in England.
2. His music seems _____ **(influence)** by the rock culture of the seventies.
3. _____ **(hurt)** badly in the past, she found it very difficult to trust anyone again.
4. Don't tease him anymore. He doesn't enjoy _____ **(laugh at)**.
5. Many film stars now hire bodyguards because they want _____ **(protect)**.
6. _____ **(award)** an Oscar was the most memorable event in the actor's life.
7. Sarah claimed _____ **(meet)** Tom Cruise while she was in America.
8. I was very upset when I failed the audition, so you can imagine how delighted I was _____ **(give)** a second chance.

9. I'm not used to _____ (**approach**) by complete strangers asking for my autograph.

10. Zain spoke slowly and loudly because he didn't want _____ (**misunderstand**).

11. I wouldn't phone Sofia after midnight. She won't like _____ (**wake up**).

12. I don't remember _____ (**tell**) the news before. Are you sure you mentioned it yesterday?

-ing/-ed adjectives

- **-ing adjectives** describe what somebody or something is. The exhibition was fascinating. (What was the exhibition like? Fascinating.)
- **-ed adjectives** describe how someone feels. The students were fascinated by the exhibition. (How did the students feel about the exhibition? Fascinated.)

Exercise: 12

Underline the correct item.

A: I didn't know you were **interesting** / **interested** in gardening.

B: I'm not. I think it's really **boring** / **bored**, but my mum's hurt her back and she was **concerning** / **concerned** that the garden would become a mess.

A: Oh, I understand now. I was really **surprising** / **surprised** to see you with a spade in your hand!

B: Don't laugh! This is really **tiring** / **tired**. I feel **exhausted** / **exhausting** already.

Exercise: 13

Fill in the gaps with an adjective ending in -ing or -ed.

Sarah has always been interested (**interest**) in cooking. Even as a young girl, she was always keeping her relatives _____ (**entertain**) with her performances at home. No one guessed, however, that by the age of eighteen she would be cooking for much larger audiences. Carla's family were _____ (**thrill**) to witness their little girl's _____ (**excite**) debut in the local town hall. Carla herself was more _____ (**excite**) and _____ (**frighten**) than she'd ever been in her life. Carla soon became famous throughout the country. And now, here she was, dancing for the Queen. How _____ (**please**) she felt! But the _____ (**amaze**) reviews she received the next day were even more _____ (**thrill**) to her!

Exercise: 14

Put the verbs in brackets into the infinitive or -ing form.

The Letter

Standing at my letterbox, I nervously ripped open the creamy white envelope. "Dear, Sarah Jones," the letter began. "We regret 1) to inform (**inform**) you that your application has been unsuccessful." I looked up. I couldn't continue 2) _____ (**read**) any further. Just then my mobile rang. It was my dad. He

wanted 3) _____ **(find out)** if I had got the job. I told him what the letter said. "Cheer up", he replied. "If you keep 4) _____ **(send out)** applications, you will find a job eventually. Can you tell me what they said?" "What's the use of 5) _____ **(read)** anymore", I replied disappointedly. I looked down at the letter again. The letter continued: "We do not feel you are experienced enough 6) _____ **(work)** in our marketing department. However, after 7) _____ **(consider)** your CV, we would like 8) _____ **(offer)** you some training for another position in our company. We would be glad 9) _____ **(meet)** with you to discuss this. We look forward to 10) _____ **(hear)** from you soon." "I suggest 11) _____ **(read)** all the way to the end next time, sweetheart!", dad said.

Exercise: 15

Choose the correct item.

1. She'd prefer _____ at the beach right now.

A being

B be

C *to be*

2. The whole audience was _____ by the clown.

A entertained

B entertaining

C entertain

3. We often go _____ in the summer.

A to sail

B sail

C sailing

4. Ali's shirt needs _____.

A to clean

B cleaning

C clean

5. She was only pretending _____.

A read

B to read

C reading

6. The day was too nice _____ indoors.

A to stay

B stay

C staying

7. I'm hoping to _____ by two o'clock.

A leave

B have left

C leaving

8. Always remember _____ your seatbelt.

A fasten

B to fasten

C fastening

Exercise: 16

Read the text. Choose the correct grammar form for the words in capitals and fill in the gaps.

Hands up who's addicted to sugar!

Do you enjoy 1) eating (**eat**) sweets every day? Do you have a hard time 2) _____ (**say**) no when someone offers you a piece of chocolate? Do you walk into shops only 3) _____ (**buy**) soft drinks or sweets? If you answered "yes" to the questions above, then you're probably a sugar addict! Sugar addiction is a serious problem because it can cause many diseases. If you are someone who can't 4) _____ (**resist**) sugary foods, it's

important to act now! Spend time on the Internet 5) _____
(**learn**) about the types of food that are full of sugar. Also avoid 6)
_____ (**drink**) soft drinks and eat fruit whenever you desire
something sweet. At first, you will have difficulty 7) _____ (**cut**
down on) your favourite sweets. But very quickly, you'll appreciate
8) _____ (**feel**) healthier and fitter.